

Can anything survive in the desert?

Deserts are areas in which very little rain falls. Some are sandy and rocky places with little life. Others, such as the deserts of North America, get more rain, so more plants can grow there. Animals live in deserts, too. They have special ways of finding food and keeping cool in the burning heat.

Storing water

Like many desert plants, the organ pipe cactus can store water inside its thick, waxy stems.

Giant ears

The jackrabbit's huge ears help it listen for danger and also give off heat to help it stay cool.

Finding food...

The coyote feeds on fruit and insects—whatever it can find. It also hunts for small animals.

Globemallow

Jackrabbit

Tarantula

Hunting at night...

Rattlesnakes are expert hunters. They use heat sensors to find warm-blooded prey in the dark.

